

NOTE

Django releases a new version about every eight months, so you may see a newer version when you install Django. This project will most likely work as it's written here, even on newer versions of Django. If you want to make sure to use the same version of Django you see here, use the command **`pip install django==4.1.*`**. This will install the latest release of Django 4.1. If you have any issues related to the version you're using, see the online resources for this book at https://ehmatthes.github.io/pcc_3e.

Creating a Project in Django

Without leaving the active virtual environment (remember to look for *ll_env* in parentheses in the terminal prompt), enter the following commands to create a new project:

```
❶ (ll_env)learning_log$ django-admin startproject ll_project .
❷ (ll_env)learning_log$ ls
ll_env ll_project manage.py
❸ (ll_env)learning_log$ ls ll_project
__init__.py asgi.py settings.py urls.py wsgi.py
```

The `startproject` command ❶ tells Django to set up a new project called *ll_project*. The dot (.) at the end of the command creates the new project with a directory structure that will make it easy to deploy the app to a server when we're finished developing it.

NOTE

*Don't forget this dot, or you might run into some configuration issues when you deploy the app. If you forget the dot, delete the files and folders that were created (except *ll_env*) and run the command again.*

Running the `ls` command (dir on Windows) ❷ shows that Django has created a new directory called *ll_project*. It also created a *manage.py* file, which is a short program that takes in commands and feeds them to the relevant part of Django. We'll use these commands to manage tasks, such as working with databases and running servers.

The *ll_project* directory contains four files ❸; the most important are *settings.py*, *urls.py*, and *wsgi.py*. The *settings.py* file controls how Django interacts with your system and manages your project. We'll modify a few of these settings and add some settings of our own as the project evolves. The *urls.py* file tells Django which pages to build in response to browser requests. The *wsgi.py* file helps Django serve the files it creates. The filename is an acronym for "web server gateway interface."

Creating the Database

Django stores most of the information for a project in a database, so next we need to create a database that Django can work with. Enter the following command (still in an active environment):

```
(ll_env)learning_log$ python manage.py migrate
```

❶ Operations to perform: